Even more interesting was the claim that she had not enforced the Jail Manual stipulation, of making jail escapees wear red caps, on Charles Sobhraj. He had been there much before Kiran became IG (P) and his escape and recapture also had taken much before her time. He has never been made to wear a red cap and yet no jail official had ever been charged with favouring him on this count. The Punjab Prison Manual that governed the Tihar Jail since its creation in the 1950s was slightly amended only as late as 1988 to become the Delhi Prison Manual. As mentioned earlier, till 1988, the manual also stipulated that 'all women prisoners were to be transferred to the women's prison in Lahore [now in Pakistan]'. Obviously, the Delhi Jail Manual has to be completely rewritten and updated to relate realistically to the present-day Indian reality as against that of British colonial times. And, as it exists, it has to be followed more in the spirit than in the letter.

Anil Baijal, home secretary in the Delhi Administration (who was later asked to relinquish his post) stated to the press (*The Hindustan Times*, 21 April 1995) that a confirmed report had been sought from the IG (Prisons) about her alleged favoured treatment to Charles Sobhraj and that a reply was being awaited by his office. Kiran, for her part, claimed that she learnt of this only from the newspapers. The journalists came to know of it much before she herself did. The moment she got this letter she promptly wrote to the lieutenant governor of Delhi and also faxed a message to the Department of Home Affairs (National Capital Territory, Delhi) pointing out that the concerned officials should at least read the rules and regulations themselves before charging anyone with breaking them. One cannot fault her for this 'request' because the Department of Home Affairs had a complete legal secretariat that could have given its officials proper advice. This would certainly have saved them from jumping the gun, which only gave the impression that they were only too keen to pin something on her.

Finally, came the leaked news in the *Indian Express* dated 21 April 1995, which rocked all those connected with Tihar and many others, of Kiran being asked to shift:

SHIFT OUT KIRAN BEDI, DAVE TELLS MINISTRY

Lt. Governor P. K. Dave has asked the Union Home Ministry to transfer the high-profile Tihar Jail Inspector General, Ms Kiran Bedi, on the ground of manipulating foreign tours and taking 'populist measures'.

In a letter to Union Home Secretary K. Padmanabhaiah, the Lt. Governor said that Ms Bedi, in her desire to get publicity, was taking measures that could compromise the security requirements of the prison. Around 8000 [actually more than 9500] prisoners are currently lodged in the jail.

In the two-page letter written late last month, Mr Dave had cited instances where people were allowed inside the prison without screening. One occasion was on *Rakshabandhan* day. Another example was the visit of the United States Embassy officials to the prison.

Mr Dave also referred to the alleged filming of the prison by foreign media and the general 'populist stance' taken by Ms Bedi.

The senior Home Ministry officials chose to keep silent about the contents of the letter, but they confirmed that the written intimation had been sent to the Ministry requesting the transfer of the first woman Indian Police Service officer.

The letter talks about the Tihar jail chief manipulating trips to various foreign countries such as Denmark and [the] United Kingdom. While the Denmark trip was sponsored by the Delhi-based United Nations office, the UK trip was organised by the British High Commission.

However, in both the cases, there was no formal letter to the Government of India and Ms